Jordi Martínez-Muñoz
| Curriculum Vitae

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Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Economics, University of California, San Diego

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego — **CA, USA**
Ph.D. in Economics — *Expected 2027*

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM) — **Ciudad de México, México**
M.S. in Economic Theory — *July 2019*

Universidad de Costa Rica (UCR) — **Costa Rica**
B.S. in Economics — *October 2015*

FIELDS

Experimental and Behavioral Economics; Microeconomic Theory

REFERENCES

Emanuel Vespa (Chair)
evespa@ucsd.edu

Isabel Trevino
itrevino@ucsd.edu

Joel Sobel
jsobel@ucsd.edu

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Beyond the Exploration-Exploitation Trade-off: The Behavioral Structure of Switching between Alternatives"

Many sequential decision problems (research and development, investment projects, and contractual relationships) involve choosing between alternatives whose quality can only be learned through experience. Choosing an alternative of uncertain quality provides information about its underlying quality, but at the cost of less predictable payoffs relative to more familiar alternatives. A central prediction of normative models of sequential experimentation is that switching decisions respond to changes in information about alternatives' relative qualities.

I test this prediction: whether switching requires a change in information. In an incentivized one-armed bandit experiment, a repeated choice between a known-quality option and a quality-uncertain one, the prediction takes a simple form, single switching: try the uncertain option until it pays or enough failures accumulate, then stay with one option for good. I find that about half of subjects change alternatives without any new information, and this is not exclusive to the need to explore, as it persists even after the alternatives' qualities are fully known. More generally, people respond to outcomes that carry no information. Those who switch this way explore inferior alternatives more and earn 20 to 25% less.

Additional treatments reveal heterogeneity in the sources of this behavior. When subjects can choose plans that partly or fully limit their reaction to round-by-round outcomes, about half of those who deviated from single switching adopt it, consistent with noisy execution of a correct plan. The rest choose plans that keep switching, consistent with an incorrect model of the problem or non-standard preferences.

OTHER WORKING PAPERS

- *Legal Information as an Input to Health Risk Assessments: Evidence from E-Cigarettes in Latin America* (with Fernando Briseño, José Antonio Márquez, and Víctor Pérez). When the health risks of an

activity are uncertain, individuals may use its legal status as a signal when assessing those risks. We use a randomized survey experiment in Mexico, Argentina, and Chile (3,600 respondents) to test whether information about e-cigarette regulation causes individuals to update their perceptions of health risk. Learning the legal status leaves perceived health risk unchanged, including among respondents whose prior beliefs are contradicted by the information. Yet, beliefs across countries align with their respective regulatory regimes.

- *Work in Progress. The Role of Risk in Strategic Exploration.* I experimentally study how the payoff distribution of the familiar arm affects behavior in a one-armed strategic-experimentation problem. In particular, I examine the empirical validity of the model's prediction of under-exploration across different payoff distributions of the familiar arm.
- *Work in Progress. Forecast Distortions, Choice Distortions: Testing the Reach of the Gambler's and Hot-Hand Fallacies.* The gambler's and hot-hand fallacies document that people's beliefs about a known random process deviate from its stated probability after a short observed streak. I test whether this belief distortion carries through to a real, incentivized choice between two known-probability options, or whether choice remains anchored to the correct probability regardless of the streak just observed.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee: *Games and Economic Behavior*

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of California, San Diego
Research Assistant, Economics Lab (Prof. Emanuel Vespa) *Jan–Jun 2024*
- Managed and conducted laboratory sessions at the UCSD Economics Lab.

Centro de Estudios Educativos y Sociales (CEES), México
Junior Researcher *2019–2020*
- Collaboration on projects analyzing social programs in Honduras and the efficiency of social spending in the Northern Triangle countries of Central America (Guatemala, Honduras, and El Salvador).
- Translated the code for the 2018 Mexican Multidimensional Poverty Index from Stata to SPSS (July 2019).

Universidad de Costa Rica
Research Assistant *Jan 2016*
- Conducted and supervised interviews for the project "Commonalities and Differences in the Meaning of Happiness: People's Voices About Ideal Happiness," funded by the Toyota Foundation. Collected data across 25 towns in Costa Rica over 3 weeks. Professor: Yoshiaki Takahashi, University of Tsukuba.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Main Instructor
University of California, San Diego
Intermediate Microeconomics, ECON 100B *Summer 2024*
Decisions Under Uncertainty, ECON 171 *Summer 2025*

Universidad de Costa Rica *2016–2017*
- Introduction to Economics for Non-Economists, XE-156
- Economic Data laboratory course. Introduce students to Stata programming (Teaching assistant).

Teaching Assistant
University of California, San Diego *2021–Present*

- School of Global Policy and Strategy: Microeconomics for Policy/Management (Master's level course), Fall 2021–2025
- Economics Department: ECON 100A, 100B, 120B, 120C, 142, 144
- Rady School of Management: MGT 160 (Experiments in Firms), MGR 444 (MBA, Topics in Business Strategy)

TEACHING TRAINING

- Summer Graduate Teaching Scholar Program, UC San Diego Engaged Teaching and Learning Commons, Summer 2024
- Engaged Teaching Scholar in Student-Centered College Teaching, UC San Diego Engaged Teaching and Learning Commons, Summer 2024
- Leadership in Teaching: Graduate Peer Review of Instruction Program, UC San Diego Engaged Teaching and Learning Commons, Summer 2024

PRESENTATIONS

- Theory, Behavioral and Experimental Workshop, UC San Diego, Department of Economics

AWARDS

- UC San Diego Yankelovich Graduate Research Funding Scholarship, 2025
- UC San Diego Economics Department Travel and Research Grant, Spring 2023 and Fall 2024
- Honorable mention for Master's Thesis: *Three Models of Menu Preferences with Costly Choice*, July 2019
- First place (out of 25 groups) in Lecturer Evaluation Survey, Introduction to Economics, UCR, Spring 2017

OTHER INFORMATION

Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), Portuguese (basic)

Programming: Microsoft Office, Stata, R, EViews, Tableau, LaTeX, MATLAB, Python, oTree, HTML, SPSS (basic)